

اردو شاعری

URDU FOR POETRY LOVERS

VOLUME 2 • FROM WORDS TO MEANING

*100 new words • working grammar • compound expressions
and 20 guided readings from the classical ghazal*

Prepared for

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What Changes in Volume 2

Volume 1 taught you what poetry talks about. Volume 2 teaches you how a line moves. You will hear who speaks, who is addressed, what belongs to whom, where a feeling is located, whether an action happened, and where the poet turns the thought with but, if, otherwise, even or only.

1 • FIND THE ANCHOR	2 • CATCH THE GLUE	3 • LOCATE THE VERB	4 • FIND THE TURN
Begin with a known image: dil, yaad, dard, ishq, shab or safar.	Notice ka/ki/ke, ko, se, mein, par and the izafat sound -e-.	Look for hai/hain/tha/thi, hua, gaya or a recognisable -na verb.	Listen for magar, lekin, warna, phir, bhi, hi or a question word.

The Three-Pass Method

Pass 1 • Emotion • What is the dominant state—love, separation, sorrow, irony, surrender or wonder?

Pass 2 • Structure • Circle the pronouns, glue words and verb. Mark the word that changes the direction.

Pass 3 • Poetry • Ask what image or contradiction makes the couplet larger than its literal meaning.

Your new milestone • Do not aim to translate every line. Aim to explain the relationship between its parts: who, where, what action, what turn, and what emotional image.

The Ten Worlds of Volume 2

WORDS	WORLD	WHAT IT UNLOCKS
1-10	Who Speaks, Who Is Addressed	Pronouns are the hidden skeleton of a lyric. Learn who says I, who becomes you, and how the beloved can remain deliberately unnamed.
11-20	The Relationship Glue	These small markers tell you who belongs to whom, where something rests, where it came from, and how far a feeling travels.
21-30	How a Thought Turns	A couplet often pivots on if, but, then, again, even or only. Catching the turn is often more useful than translating every noun.
31-40	Questions, Negation and Suggestion	Urdu poetry loves questions that are not requests for information. They may complain, tease, surrender, challenge or leave meaning suspended.
41-50	Time, Distance and Presence	The ghazal makes emotional geography from today and tomorrow, here and there, nearness and distance, absence and sudden presence.
51-60	Ten Verbs That Move the Line	Infinitives end in -na. Recognising the stem lets you follow who comes, goes, remains, meets, sees, says, hears or gives.
61-70	Ten Verbs of Desire and Loss	These verbs carry the central drama of lyric poetry: taking, keeping, losing, finding, wanting, asking, weeping, laughing, living and dying.
71-80	Judgement and Inner Weather	A few adjectives tell you whether the moment is good or bad, easy or difficult, naive, troubled, abundant, diminished or melancholy.
81-90	The Classical Turn of Feeling	These literary pivots convert an event into poetry: condition, cause, remedy, news, effect, grace, cruelty, grievance, fault and artistry.
91-100	Curtain, Door and Journey	Poetic space is never neutral. Curtains conceal, doors refuse, walls divide, roads invite, destinations recede, and ruined homelands hold memory.

Grammar 1 • Pronouns and the Verb ‘To Be’

Urdu does not use separate words for he and she in the third person. Yeh and woh point by nearness or distance; context and verb agreement may reveal gender.

PERSON	PRESENT	PAST (M/F)	POETRY EXAMPLE
main • I	main hoon	main tha / thi	main tanha hoon • I am alone
ham • we / poetic I	ham hain	ham the / thin	ham beqaraar hain • we are restless
tu • intimate you	tu hai	tu tha / thi	tu meri dua hai • you are my prayer
tum • familiar you	tum ho	tum the / thin	tum paas ho • you are near
aap • respectful you	aap hain	aap the / thin	aap ka karam hai • it is your grace
yeh / woh • this/that person	yeh/woh hai	yeh/woh tha / thi	woh udaas hai • that person is sad

Possession Changes with the Thing Possessed

Ka, ki and ke agree with the following noun. The owner does not decide the ending. This is why the same person can say mera dil, meri yaad and mere khwaab.

OWNER	MASC. SINGULAR	FEMININE	MASC. PLURAL / OBLIQUE
I	mera dil	meri yaad	mere khwaab
we	hamaara safar	hamaari manzil	hamaare armaan
you • tu	tera gham	teri dua	tere aansoo
you • tum	tumhaara haal	tumhaari nazar	tumhaare raaz
you • aap	aapka karam	aapki nigaah	aapke alfaaz
that person	uska dil	uski zulf	uske khwaab

Grammar 2 • Read Relationships Before Word Order

Default listening frame: subject → object / setting → verb. Poetry may rearrange this for rhythm and emphasis, so trust markers more than position.

URDU ORDER	MARKER-BY-MARKER	NATURAL ENGLISH
main tum ko dekhta hoon	I • you [object] • see • am	I see you
dil mein raaz hai	heart • in • secret • is	There is a secret in the heart
woh gham se rota hai	that person • sorrow • from • weeps	That person weeps from sorrow
ham raah par chalte hain	we • road • on • walk	We walk on the road

The Small Marker ne

Recognition rule • With many completed actions, ne marks the doer: tum ne kaha, you said; Mir ne likha, Mir wrote. Do not force a one-word English translation. Hear it as a completed-action signal attached to the actor.

Questions Often Perform Emotion

FORM	LITERAL JOB	POETIC FORCE
kya hua?	what happened?	concern, shock or self-questioning
kyun?	why?	complaint, protest or helplessness
kab milenge?	when will we meet?	longing and suspended time
kaun jaane?	who knows?	uncertainty or surrender
kahan...kahan...	where X, where Y	contrast between unequal things

Grammar 3 • Recognise the Verb Without Conjugating Everything

The dictionary form ends in -na. Remove -na to hear the stem, then notice a small set of recurring endings. Recognition is enough at this stage.

INFINITIVE	STEM	COMPLETED	COMMAND	CONTINUING
aana • come	aa-	aaya / aayi	aao	aa raha / rahi
jaana • go	jaa-	gaya / gayi	jaao	jaa raha / rahi
karna • do	kar-	kiya / ki	karo	kar raha / rahi
kehna • say	keh-	kaha	kaho	keh raha / rahi
dekhna • see	dekh-	dekha / dekhi	dekho	dekh raha / rahi
lena • take	le-	liya / li	lo	le raha / rahi

Five High-Value Signals

hai / hain • is / are; present state

tha / thi / the • was / were; past state and gender/number clue

hua / hui / hue • happened or became

gaya / gayi / gaye • went; or an action became fully completed

raha / rahi / rahe • an action is/was continuing

Grammar 4 • Negation, Emphasis and the Turn

SIGNAL	CORE JOB	EXAMPLE	LISTEN FOR
nahin	not / no	woh nahin aaya	plain negation or refusal
na	not / do not	mujhe bhool na jaana	soft plea or alternative
mat	do not	door mat jaao	direct prohibition
bhi	also / even	gham bhi, sukoon bhi	addition or intensification
hi	only / precisely	tum hi	exclusive focus
magar / lekin	but	chaaha magar paaya nahin	contradiction
warna	otherwise	aa jaao warna...	counterfactual or punch line
goya	as if	goya khwaab ho	image held as possibility

Two Persian Connectors You Already Hear

Izafat • -e- / -i- • Links 'of' or adjective to noun: dil-e-naadaan, haal-e-dil, raah-e-ishq, aalam-e-na-paayedaar.	The -o- connector • Means 'and' inside Persianised compounds: aib-o-hunar, dar-o-deewar, ranj-o-gham, husn-o-jamaal.
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Who Speaks, Who Is Addressed

بولنے والا اور مخاطب

Pronouns are the hidden skeleton of a lyric. Learn who says I, who becomes you, and how the beloved can remain deliberately unnamed.

01 • MAIN • میں

Meaning • I; the speaker referring to oneself **Connection** • Pairs with hoon: main hoon, I am. Do not confuse it with mein, meaning in.

Memory hook • The title “Main Shayar To Nahin” begins with a direct declaration: I.

Try it • main tanha hoon = I am alone

02 • HAM • ہم

Meaning • we; sometimes a dignified poetic I **Connection** • A poet may use ham for the self, creating distance, modesty or grandeur.

Memory hook • “Hum Tum” gives you the two sides of many lyrics: we/I and you.

Try it • ham beqaraar hain = we are restless

03 • TU • تو

Meaning • you; intimate, familiar, devotional or disrespectful by context **Connection** • More intimate than tum; in prayer it can express closeness to God rather than rudeness.

Memory hook • “Tu Hi Re” makes tu feel direct, singular and emotionally close.

Try it • tu meri dua hai = you are my prayer

04 • TUM • تم

Meaning • you; familiar and widely used **Connection** • Pairs with ho: tum ho. It may address one person warmly or more than one person.

Memory hook • The film title “Hum Tum” is a complete pronoun lesson.

Try it • tum paas ho = you are near

05 • AAP • آپ

Meaning • you; respectful or formal **Connection** • Pairs with hain and possessives aapka, aapki, aapke.

Memory hook • Hear the respectful distance in titles beginning “Aap Ki...”

Try it • aap ka karam = your kindness

06 • WOH • وہ

Meaning • that; he, she or they by context **Connection** • Urdu pronouns do not mark gender here; the verb and context may reveal it.

Memory hook • “Woh Lamhe” points away from the speaker toward those remembered moments.

Try it • woh mera khwaab hai = that person is my dream

07 • YEH • یہ

Meaning • this; he, she or they nearby by context **Connection** • Contrasts with woh. In speech both may sound closer to ye and vo.

Memory hook • The title “Yeh Jo Mohabbat Hai” begins by pointing: this thing called love.

Try it • yeh dard kya hai = what is this pain?

08 • KOI • کوئی

Meaning • someone, anyone, some **Connection** • With nahin it becomes nobody or none: koi nahin.

Memory hook • “Koi Fariyaad” begins with an indefinite presence: some lament.

Try it • koi yaad aaya = someone came to mind

09 • SAB • سب

Meaning • all, everyone, everything **Connection** • Sab can gather people or things; sab kuchh means everything.

Memory hook • “Sab Kuchh Seekha” makes sab expand into the whole of something.

Try it • sab jaante hain = everyone knows

10 • KHUD • خود

Meaning • self; oneself; personally **Connection** • Builds khud par, khud se and khud ko; khudaa is a different word.

Memory hook • Think of khud as the inward mirror: the person turns toward the self.

Try it • khud par yaqeen = belief in oneself

The Relationship Glue

رشتوں کو جوڑنے والے لفظ

These small markers tell you who belongs to whom, where something rests, where it came from, and how far a feeling travels.

11 • KA • کا

Meaning • of; belonging to, used with a masculine singular noun **Connection** • Changes to ki or ke according to what follows, not according to the owner.

Memory hook • dil ka dard is pain belonging to the heart.

Try it • dil ka raaz = the heart's secret

12 • KI • کی

Meaning • of; belonging to, used with a feminine noun **Connection** • The owner may be any gender; ki agrees with the possessed noun.

Memory hook • yaad is grammatically feminine, so teri yaad and dil ki yaad use ki forms.

Try it • raat ki khaamoshi = the night's silence

13 • KE • کے

Meaning • of; belonging to, used with masculine plural or oblique forms **Connection** • Also appears before many postpositions: dil ke paas, ishq ke bina.

Memory hook • Hear it as the flexible third member of ka-ki-ke.

Try it • gham ke saaye = shadows of sorrow

14 • KO • کو

Meaning • to; toward; marks a recipient or object **Connection** • Dil ko can mean to the heart or the heart as object.

Memory hook • In dil ko samjhaao, the heart is the one being persuaded.

Try it • mujh ko yaad hai = I remember it

15 • SE • سے

Meaning • from, with, by, than **Connection** • One tiny word can mark source, instrument or comparison.

Memory hook • dil se means from the heart; chaand se roshan means brighter than the moon.

Try it • dil se kaho = say it from the heart

16 • MEIN • میں

Meaning • in, inside, within **Connection** • Spelled like main, I, but pronounced with a different vowel.

Memory hook • dil mein places an entire world inside the heart.

Try it • dil mein raaz hai = there is a secret in the heart

17 • PAR • پر

Meaning • on, upon, at; sometimes but **Connection** • Context separates the postposition from the poetic conjunction meaning but.

Memory hook • khud par yaqeen puts confidence upon the self.

Try it • raah par tanha = alone on the road

18 • TAK • تک

Meaning • until, up to, as far as **Connection** • Marks an endpoint in time, distance or intensity.

Memory hook • raat se sahar tak stretches the image from night all the way to dawn.

Try it • umr bhar tak = until the end of a lifetime

19 • LIYE • لیے

Meaning • for; for the sake of **Connection** • Usually appears with ke: ke liye. The pronunciation is often liye or liye.

Memory hook • tere liye is one of the most familiar phrases in film music.

Try it • tere liye dua = a prayer for you

20 • BAGHAIR • بغیر

Meaning • without **Connection** • Often follows a noun with ke: us ke baghair, without that person.

Memory hook • The title idea “tere bina” maps directly to the more literary tere baghair.

Try it • tere baghair tanha = lonely without you

How a Thought Turns

خیال کا موڑ

A couplet often pivots on if, but, then, again, even or only. Catching the turn is often more useful than translating every noun.

21 • JO • جو

Meaning • who, which, that; the one who **Connection** • Jo often opens a relative clause and later connects to woh: jo...woh...

Memory hook • Hear jo as a hook waiting for completion: the one who...

Try it • jo dil mein hai = what is in the heart

22 • JAB • جب

Meaning • when **Connection** • Often pairs with tab, then, even if tab is omitted.

Memory hook • The line moves in time as soon as jab appears.

Try it • jab tum aaye = when you came

23 • AGAR • اگر

Meaning • if **Connection** • Creates a condition; poetry may leave the consequence delayed until the second line.

Memory hook • Agar opens a door: if this happens, what follows?

Try it • agar woh aaye = if that person comes

24 • MAGAR • مگر

Meaning • but, however **Connection** • A compact turn from expectation to contradiction.

Memory hook • The first half hopes; magar changes the emotional weather.

Try it • chaaha magar paaya nahin = wanted, but did not attain

25 • LEKIN • لیکن

Meaning • but, however **Connection** • More conversational than magar, though common in modern poetry and songs.

Memory hook • Use it as a clear audible hinge between two thoughts.

Try it • dard hai lekin sukoon bhi = there is pain, but peace too

26 • WARNA • ورنہ

Meaning • otherwise; or else **Connection** • Often introduces the imagined alternative that did not occur.

Memory hook • In a witty couplet, warna can sharpen the punch line.

Try it • aa jaao warna der hogi = come, otherwise it will be late

27 • PHIR • پھر

Meaning • again; then; after that **Connection** • Can return to a feeling or advance the sequence.

Memory hook • “Phir Le Aaya Dil” uses phir as the return of the heart.

Try it • phir yaad aaya = remembered again

28 • AB • اب

Meaning • now **Connection** • Pulls the poem into the present after memory, waiting or change.

Memory hook • Ab often signals that something can no longer remain as before.

Try it • ab kya kahen = what can we say now?

29 • BHI • بھی

Meaning • also, too, even **Connection** • Adds or intensifies; position changes emphasis.

Memory hook • tum bhi means you too; mar kar bhi means even after dying.

Try it • dard bhi sukoon bhi = pain too, peace too

30 • HI • ہی

Meaning • indeed, precisely, only **Connection** • Focuses the word before it: tum hi means you alone or precisely you.

Memory hook • “Tu Hi Re” uses hi to make the addressee exclusive.

Try it • tum hi mehboob ho = you alone are the beloved

Questions, Negation and Suggestion

سوال، نفی اور اشارہ

Urdu poetry loves questions that are not requests for information. They may complain, tease, surrender, challenge or leave meaning suspended.

31 • KYA • کیا

Meaning • what; also a question marker **Connection** • At the start it can make a yes/no question; elsewhere it may mean what.

Memory hook • “Kya Mujhe Pyaar Hai” begins with the question marker.

Try it • yeh kya hai = what is this?

32 • KYUN • کیوں

Meaning • why **Connection** • Can seek a cause, complain or dramatise helplessness.

Memory hook • A poetic kyun may be addressed to the beloved, fate, heart or God.

Try it • dil kyun udaas hai = why is the heart sad?

33 • KAISE • کیسے

Meaning • how; in what manner **Connection** • May ask about method or express disbelief: how could this be?

Memory hook • Kaise turns certainty into wonder or protest.

Try it • kaise kahen = how can we say it?

34 • KAUN • کون

Meaning • who **Connection** • Often used rhetorically when the answer is no one or unknowable.

Memory hook • “Kaun Hai Jo Sapnon Mein Aaya” begins with the mystery of identity.

Try it • woh kaun hai = who is that person?

35 • KAHAN • کہاں

Meaning • where **Connection** • Can be literal place or a contrast meaning where is X compared with Y?

Memory hook • Distance becomes audible when a lyric asks kahan.

Try it • manzil kahan hai = where is the destination?

36 • KAB • کب

Meaning • when **Connection** • Unlike jab, which links an event, kab asks for its time.

Memory hook • Waiting turns into a question: kab aaoge?

Try it • visaal kab hoga = when will union happen?

37 • NAHIN • نہیں

Meaning • not; no **Connection** • Negates statements and combines with koi, kuchh or kabhi.

Memory hook • A repeated nahin can create refusal, impossibility or teasing suspense.

Try it • main tanha nahin = I am not alone

38 • NA • نہ

Meaning • not; do not; or, in repeated alternatives **Connection** • Softer and more flexible than nahin; also appears in ho ki na ho.

Memory hook • In invitations and pleas, na can sound tender rather than harsh.

Try it • mujhe bhool na jaana = do not forget me

39 • MAT • مت

Meaning • do not; prohibitive marker **Connection** • Comes before a command stem: mat jao, do not go.

Memory hook • The lyric becomes an appeal when mat precedes jaana.

Try it • door mat jao = do not go far

40 • GOYA • گویا

Meaning • as if, so to speak **Connection** • Creates an imagined equivalence without asserting it literally.

Memory hook • Momin's famous tum mere paas hote ho goya makes imagined presence vivid.

Try it • goya khwaab ho = as if it were a dream

Time, Distance and Presence

وقت، دوری اور موجودگی

The ghazal makes emotional geography from today and tomorrow, here and there, nearness and distance, absence and sudden presence.

41 • AAJ • آج

Meaning • today **Connection** • Contrasts with kal, which can mean yesterday or tomorrow.

Memory hook • Aaj brings decision, meeting or loss into the immediate day.

Try it • aaj dil udaas hai = today the heart is sad

42 • KAL • کل

Meaning • yesterday or tomorrow; context decides **Connection** • Verb tense and surrounding words reveal whether kal looks backward or forward.

Memory hook • The ambiguity itself suits poetry: one word touches past and future.

Try it • kal phir milenge = we will meet again tomorrow

43 • KABHI • کبھی

Meaning • sometimes, ever, at some time **Connection** • With nahin: never. Repeated kabhi...kabhi means sometimes this, sometimes that.

Memory hook • "Kabhi Kabhie" turns changing moments into the title itself.

Try it • kabhi yaad karna = remember me sometime

44 • HAMESHA • ہمیشہ

Meaning • always **Connection** • A large promise, often tested by waqt and judaai.

Memory hook • Pair it mentally with kabhi: sometime versus always.

Try it • hamesha tera khayaal = always the thought of you

45 • YAHAN • یہاں

Meaning • here **Connection** • The near place, often the speaker's present reality.

Memory hook • Yahan can be a room, city, world or emotional condition.

Try it • yahan koi nahin = there is no one here

46 • WAHAN • وہاں

Meaning • there **Connection** • Contrasts with yahan and may point toward the beloved's world.

Memory hook • A single wahan can make the beloved feel geographically unreachable.

Try it • woh wahan hai = that person is there

47 • KAHIN • کہیں

Meaning • somewhere, anywhere; sometimes perhaps **Connection** • With nahin it means nowhere; with na it can express a warning.

Memory hook • Kahin turns a fixed map into an uncertain possibility.

Try it • kahin door = somewhere far away

48 • PAAS • پاس

Meaning • near, beside; in one's possession **Connection** • Mere paas can mean near me or with me / in my possession.

Memory hook • Momin's tum mere paas hote ho makes nearness emotionally unforgettable.

Try it • mere paas raho = stay near me

49 • DOOR • دور

Meaning • far, distant **Connection** • May describe space, relationship, time or spiritual distance.

Memory hook • The title "Kahin Door Jab Din Dhal Jaye" begins with remoteness.

Try it • dil se door = far from the heart

50 • SAAMNE • سامنے

Meaning • in front of, before, face-to-face **Connection** • The opposite of hidden behind parda or chilman.

Memory hook • "Nazar Ke Samne" places the object directly before the gaze.

Try it • mere saamne = in front of me

Ten Verbs That Move the Line

شعر کو چلانے والے فعل

Infinitives end in -na. Recognising the stem lets you follow who comes, goes, remains, meets, sees, says, hears or gives.

51 • HONA • ہونا

Meaning • to be, happen or become **Connection** • Forms include hai, hain, hoon, ho, tha, thi, the and hua.

Memory hook • Hona is the invisible engine behind identity and change.

Try it • kya hua = what happened?

52 • KARNA • کرنا

Meaning • to do, make or perform **Connection** • Combines with nouns: yaad karna, intezaar karna, gila karna.

Memory hook • Once you know karna, many nouns become actions.

Try it • yaad karna = to remember

53 • AANA • آنا

Meaning • to come **Connection** • Aaya, aayi, aaye mark completed coming by gender/number.

Memory hook • Memories, dawn, beloveds and tears all aate hain—come.

Try it • yaad aana = to come to mind

54 • JAANA • جانا

Meaning • to go; also a passive/helper verb in compounds **Connection** • Jaao is go; gaya is went. With bhool, bhool jaana means forget completely.

Memory hook • “Aaj Jaane Ki Zid Na Karo” makes jaana the requested departure.

Try it • door jaana = to go far away

55 • REHNA • رہنا

Meaning • to stay, remain, live **Connection** • Raho is stay; raha/rahi also helps form continuing actions.

Memory hook • A poet may ask the beloved to stay or describe what remains after loss.

Try it • paas rehna = to remain near

56 • MILNA • ملنا

Meaning • to meet, be found, receive or unite **Connection** • Milna can describe people meeting or something becoming available.

Memory hook • In love poetry, milna ranges from an encounter to visaal.

Try it • phir milenge = we will meet again

57 • DEKHNA • دیکھنا

Meaning • to see, look at, witness **Connection** • Dekha is saw; dekho is look. The gaze may heal, expose or wound.

Memory hook • Nazar is the noun; dekhna is the act.

Try it • tum ko dekhna = to see you

58 • KEHNA • کہنا

Meaning • to say, tell or call **Connection** • Kaha is said; kahen can mean may we say / what shall we say.

Memory hook • Poetry often stages speech that ordinary life could not permit.

Try it • dil ki baat kehna = to speak the heart's matter

59 • SUNNA • سننا

Meaning • to hear, listen **Connection** • Suna is heard; suno is listen. It may also mean to learn by report.

Memory hook • A ghazal asks to be heard before it asks to be translated.

Try it • meri faryaad suno = listen to my appeal

60 • DENA • دینا

Meaning • to give, allow or cause **Connection** • Diya, di, diye agree with what was given; compounds add completion.

Memory hook • Dil dena is to give one's heart; jawaab dena is to answer.

Try it • dil dena = to give the heart

Ten Verbs of Desire and Loss

خواہش اور زیاں کے فعل

These verbs carry the central drama of lyric poetry: taking, keeping, losing, finding, wanting, asking, weeping, laughing, living and dying.

61 • LENA • لینا

Meaning • to take, receive or bring an action to oneself **Connection** • Liya, li, liye mark completed taking; often pairs with dena.

Memory hook • Dil lena and dil dena create a whole romance with two verbs.

Try it • dil le liya = took the heart

62 • RAKHNA • رکھنا

Meaning • to keep, place or maintain **Connection** • Rakha, rakhi, rakhe; can preserve a promise or position an object.

Memory hook • Raaz rakhna turns secrecy into an action: to keep a secret.

Try it • yaad rakhna = to remember / keep in mind

63 • KHONA • کھونا

Meaning • to lose **Connection** • Khoya can mean lost or absorbed; kho dena intensifies completion.

Memory hook • Hosh khona is to lose one's senses; khud ko khona is to lose oneself.

Try it • sukoon khona = to lose peace

64 • PAANA • پانا

Meaning • to obtain, attain, find **Connection** • Pairs naturally with khona: loss and attainment.

Memory hook • A tamanna becomes fulfilled only when the desired thing is paaya.

Try it • manzil paana = to reach the destination

65 • CHAHNA • چاہنا

Meaning • to want; to love **Connection** • Context decides whether it means desire for something or affection for someone.

Memory hook • Main tumhe chahta hoon is both wanting and loving.

Try it • tum ko chahna = to love you

66 • MAANGNA • مانگنا

Meaning • to ask for, request, seek **Connection** • A lover may ask for visaal; a devotee may ask in dua.

Memory hook • Dua maangna makes prayer an act of asking.

Try it • dua maangna = to ask in prayer

67 • RONA • رونا

Meaning • to cry, weep **Connection** • Rona is wept; rote rote means while repeatedly weeping.

Memory hook • Mir's bedside couplet turns rote rote into exhaustion before sleep.

Try it • gham mein rona = to weep in sorrow

68 • HANSNA • ہنسنا

Meaning • to laugh, smile **Connection** • The emotional counterpoint to rona, though a smile can conceal pain.

Memory hook • A face may hansna while the heart carries gham.

Try it • hans kar kehna = to say with a smile

69 • JEENA • جینا

Meaning • to live **Connection** • Jiya is lived; jeene ke liye means in order to live.

Memory hook • Love songs often make jeena depend on presence, memory or hope.

Try it • ishq mein jeena = to live in love

70 • MARNA • مرنا

Meaning • to die; to be devoted to someone in idiom **Connection** • Mara is died; marna can be literal, exaggerated or mystical self-effacement.

Memory hook • In the ghazal, death may mean physical death, surrender or intensity.

Try it • gham se marna = to die of sorrow

Judgement and Inner Weather

صفت اور باطنی کیفیت

A few adjectives tell you whether the moment is good or bad, easy or difficult, naive, troubled, abundant, diminished or melancholy.

71 • ACHCHHA • اچھا

Meaning • good, fine, well **Connection** • Changes to achchhi/achchhe; also works as a conversational response.

Memory hook • Ghalib's bimar ka haal achchha hai uses outward wellness ironically.

Try it • haal achchha hai = the condition is good

72 • BURA • برا

Meaning • bad, wrong, morally objectionable **Connection** • Changes to buri/bure. With maanna, bura maanna means take offence.

Memory hook • Zafar's self-reflective couplet asks who still looks bad after self-examination.

Try it • koi bura nahin = no one is bad

73 • KHOOB • خوب

Meaning • very, excellently; beautiful or fine **Connection** • Can intensify praise or sharpen irony: khoob parda hai.

Memory hook • Dagh begins with khoob and then exposes an imperfect concealment.

Try it • khoob kaha = well said

74 • KAM • کم

Meaning • less, few, insufficient **Connection** • Contrasts with zyada; also appears in kam se kam, at least.

Memory hook • Ghalib's desires are many, yet still feel kam.

Try it • bahut kam = very little

75 • ZYADA • زیادہ

Meaning • more, excessive **Connection** • Contrasts with kam and can quantify feeling, time or distance.

Memory hook • A little gham becomes dramatic when it grows zyada.

Try it • zyada door = too far

76 • AASAN • آسان

Meaning • easy **Connection** • Contrasts with mushkil; Ghalib famously makes difficulties become easy through repetition.

Memory hook • The pair mushkil-aasan is a compact philosophical lesson.

Try it • sab aasan hai = everything is easy

77 • MUSHKIL • مشکل

Meaning • difficult; a difficulty or problem **Connection** • Can be adjective or noun; mushkilein is plural difficulties.

Memory hook • A ghazal often makes love impossible yet unavoidable.

Try it • mushkil safar = a difficult journey

78 • NAADAAN • نادان

Meaning • naive, innocent, unknowing **Connection** • Built into dil-e-naadaan, the naive heart addressed by Ghalib.

Memory hook • Naadaan is not merely foolish; it can carry tenderness.

Try it • dil-e-naadaan = naive heart

79 • PARESHAN • پریشان

Meaning • troubled, disturbed, scattered **Connection** • Can describe a mind or even disordered hair in older usage.

Memory hook • The word sounds like the mind it names: unable to settle.

Try it • dil pareshan hai = the heart is troubled

80 • UDAAS • اداس

Meaning • sad, melancholy, low in spirit **Connection** • Softer and quieter than intense gham or faryaad.

Memory hook • Udaas often belongs to evenings, eyes, rooms and hearts.

Try it • udaas shaam = a melancholy evening

The Classical Turn of Feeling

کلاسیکی احساس کے لفظ

These literary pivots convert an event into poetry: condition, cause, remedy, news, effect, grace, cruelty, grievance, fault and artistry.

81 • HAAL • حال

Meaning • condition, state, present situation **Connection** • Forms haal-e-dil, haal-e-zindagi and kya haal hai.

Memory hook • Many couplets reveal the lover's haal without stating it directly.

Try it • haal-e-dil = condition of the heart

82 • SABAB • سبب

Meaning • cause, reason **Connection** • Pairs with kyun: the question asks, sabab names the answer.

Memory hook • Mir's bimar hue jis ke sabab makes the source of illness the source of medicine.

Try it • dard ka sabab = the cause of pain

83 • DAWA • دوا

Meaning • medicine, remedy **Connection** • Poetry asks whether the disease of love has any cure.

Memory hook • Ghalib's dard ki dawa turns emotional pain into an illness.

Try it • gham ki dawa = the remedy for sorrow

84 • KHABAR • خبر

Meaning • news, knowledge, awareness **Connection** • Khabar hona means to know; be-khabar means unaware.

Memory hook • "Hoshwalon Ko Khabar Kya" pairs awareness with the limits of sobriety.

Try it • mujhe khabar hai = I know / I am aware

85 • ASAR • اثر

Meaning • effect, influence, impression **Connection** • A sigh, glance, prayer or word may have asar.

Memory hook • When a line changes the listener after it ends, it has left asar.

Try it • dua ka asar = the effect of prayer

86 • KARAM • کرم

Meaning • grace, favour, generosity **Connection** • Often addressed upward—to beloved, ruler, teacher or God.

Memory hook • Nigaah-e-karam is a merciful glance; one look becomes a blessing.

Try it • aap ka karam = your kindness

87 • SITAM • ستم

Meaning • cruelty, oppression, torment **Connection** • A beloved's neglect may be stylised as sitam; worldly injustice can also be literal.

Memory hook • Wafa and sitam are moral opposites in the lover's complaint.

Try it • tera sitam = your cruelty

88 • GILA • گلہ

Meaning • complaint, grievance **Connection** • Close to shikwa but often more personal and conversational.

Memory hook • Gila karna is to voice hurt without the urgency of faryaad.

Try it • dil ka gila = the heart's grievance

89 • AIB • عیب

Meaning • fault, defect, flaw **Connection** • Pairs with hunar, skill or virtue, in moral reflection.

Memory hook • Zafar's aib-o-hunar balances faults and accomplishments.

Try it • apna aib = one's own fault

90 • HUNAR • ہنر

Meaning • skill, art, talent, virtue **Connection** • The positive counterweight to aib; a poet's craft can be hunar.

Memory hook • A simple line that feels effortless may hide great hunar.

Try it • shairi ka hunar = the art of poetry

Curtain, Door and Journey

پردہ، در اور سفر

Poetic space is never neutral. Curtains conceal, doors refuse, walls divide, roads invite, destinations recede, and ruined homelands hold memory.

91 • PARDA • پردہ

Meaning • curtain, veil, concealment **Connection** • Can be literal modesty, secrecy, social distance or metaphysical hiddenness.

Memory hook • Dagh's khoob parda hai makes the veil itself perform the drama.

Try it • parda-e-raaz = veil of mystery

92 • CHILMAN • چلمن

Meaning • screen, lattice curtain or blind **Connection** • More specific and visual than parda; it allows partial concealment.

Memory hook • Imagine a figure close enough to the screen to be sensed but not fully seen.

Try it • chilman ke paas = beside the screen

93 • DAR • در

Meaning • door, threshold **Connection** • Do not confuse it with dar, fear, written در; poetic dar is written در.

Memory hook • Dar-e-yaar is the beloved's door, where the lover waits or is refused.

Try it • dar-e-mehboob = the beloved's door

94 • DEEWAR • دیوار

Meaning • wall **Connection** • May protect, divide, confine or witness a ruined home.

Memory hook • Dar-o-deewar means doors and walls: the visible body of a dwelling.

Try it • ghar ki deewar = the wall of the house

95 • RAAH • راہ

Meaning • road, way, path **Connection** • Close to raasta but more lyrical; forms raah-e-ishq and raah-e-wafa.

Memory hook • A spiritual method and a physical road can both be raah.

Try it • raah-e-ishq = the path of love

96 • MANZIL • منزل

Meaning • destination, stage of a journey **Connection** • The counterpart to safar and raah; it may remain unreachable.

Memory hook • A journey gains direction when a manzil appears.

Try it • manzil-e-ishq = the destination of love

97 • GHAR • گھر

Meaning • home, house **Connection** • Can mean physical shelter, the heart, family or belonging.

Memory hook • A lonely house in a lyric often stands for an emptied inner life.

Try it • dil ka ghar = the home of the heart

98 • SHEHAR • شہر

Meaning • city **Connection** • The public world where reputation, exile and memory become social.

Memory hook • Ghalib's shahr mein aabru places honour inside the judging city.

Try it • shehar-e-dil = city of the heart

99 • KUUCHA • کوچہ

Meaning • lane, street; especially the beloved's lane **Connection** • A classical location of waiting, humiliation, devotion and return.

Memory hook • Kuuche se nikalna means leaving the very street of attachment.

Try it • kuucha-e-yaar = the beloved's lane

100 • DAYAAR • دیار

Meaning • land, region, abode, homeland **Connection** • More elevated than ordinary jagah or desh; powerful in poetry of exile.

Memory hook • Zafar's ujde dayaar makes a homeland into a devastated emotional landscape.

Try it • dayaar-e-dil = the realm of the heart

Compound Lab • 36 Expressions Worth Hearing Whole

A compound is a shortcut into poetic thought. First recognise the two pieces; then allow the combined phrase to become one mental image.

ROMAN	URDU	MEANING
dil-e-naadaan	دلِ نادان	naive heart
haal-e-dil	حالِ دل	condition of the heart
dard-e-dil	دردِ دل	pain of the heart
dawa-e-gham	دوائے غم	remedy for sorrow
raah-e-ishq	راہِ عشق	path of love
manzil-e-ishq	منزلِ عشق	destination of love
kuucha-e-yaar	کوچہ یار	beloved's lane
dar-e-mehboob	درِ محبوب	beloved's door
parda-e-raaz	پردہ راز	veil of mystery
nigaah-e-karam	نگاہِ کرم	gracious glance
shab-e-hijr	شبِ ہجر	night of separation
lamha-e-visaal	لمحہ وصال	moment of union

COMPOUND LAB • CONTINUED

ROMAN	URDU	MEANING
dayaar-e-dil	دیارِ دل	realm of the heart
shehar-e-khaamoshi	شہرِ خاموشی	city of silence
aalam-e-tanhaai	عالمِ تنہائی	world/state of solitude
aalam-e-na-paayedaar	عالمِ ناپائیدار	impermanent world
saahib-e-hunar	صاحبِ ہنر	person of skill
be-khabar	بے خبر	unaware
be-asar	بے اثر	without effect
be-sabab	بے سبب	without cause
na-tawaan	ناتواں	weak, powerless
na-paayedaar	ناپائیدار	impermanent
dar-o-deewar	در و دیوار	doors and walls
aib-o-hunar	عیب و ہنر	faults and merits

COMPOUND LAB • CONTINUED

ROMAN	URDU	MEANING
ranj-o-gham	رنج و غم	grief and sorrow
husn-o-ishq	حسن و عشق	beauty and love
naaz-o-adaa	ناز و ادا	coy pride and grace
shab-o-roz	شب و روز	night and day
shaam-o-sahar	شام و سحر	evening and dawn
jaan-o-dil	جان و دل	life and heart; wholeheartedly
khauf-e-khuda	خوفِ خدا	awe/fear of God
yaad-e-khuda	یادِ خدا	remembrance of God
asar-e-dua	اثرِ دعا	effect of prayer
sitam-e-yaar	ستمِ یار	beloved's cruelty
gila-e-dil	گلہِ دل	heart's grievance
rang-e-bahaar	رنگِ بہار	colour of spring

Twenty Classical Couplets • Guided Close Readings

Read each couplet in three layers: the Urdu sound, the literal bridge, and the poetic turn. The English is intentionally explanatory rather than an attempt to replace the original poem.

Reading discipline • First identify only the words you know. Then use the grammar clue. Read the interpretation last, so your own encounter with the image comes first.

01 • MIRZA GHALIB

دلِ ناداں تجھے ہوا کیا ہے
آخر اس درد کی دوا کیا ہے

dil-e-naadaan tujhe hua kya hai
aakhir is dard ki dawa kya hai

Literal bridge • Naive heart, what has happened to you? After all, what is the remedy for this pain?

Poetic turn • The poet questions his own heart as though it were another person. The ordinary medical pair dard-dawa becomes a way to suggest that love is an illness whose cure may not exist.

Grammar clue • tujhe = to you; hua = happened; kya repeats first as a question word and then as 'what remedy?'

Words to catch • dil • naadaan • dard • dawa • kya • hona

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

02 • MIRZA GHALIB

ہزاروں خواہشیں ایسی کہ ہر خواہش پہ دم نکلے
بہت نکلے مرے ارمان لیکن پھر بھی کم نکلے

hazaaron khwaahishen aisi ki har khwaahish pe dam nikle
bahut nikle mere armaan lekin phir bhi kam nikle

Literal bridge • Thousands of desires, each worth a life-breath; many longings emerged, yet even then they proved too few.

Poetic turn • Desire is not merely numerous; every single wish is intense enough to consume a life. The second line gives the Ghalibian twist: even abundance cannot exhaust wanting.

Grammar clue • har = every; lekin = but; phir bhi = even then / nevertheless; kam = few or insufficient.

Words to catch • khwaahish • armaan • lekin • phir • bhi • kam

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

03 • MIRZA GHALIB

ان کے دیکھے سے جو آجاتی ہے منہ پر رونق
وہ سمجھتے ہیں کہ بیمار کا حال اچھا ہے

*un ke dekhe se jo aa jaati hai munh par raunaq
woh samajhte hain ki bimaar ka haal achchha hai*

Literal bridge • The radiance that comes to the face on seeing them—they assume the sick person's condition is good.

Poetic turn • The beloved's appearance briefly brightens the lover's face, but that visible improvement deceives the beloved. Surface beauty conceals the continuing illness of love.

Grammar clue • un ke dekhe se = from seeing them; jo links the effect; woh samajhte hain = they think.

Words to catch • dekhna • se • jo • aana • par • haal • achchha

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

04 • MIRZA GHALIB

رنج سے خوگر ہوا انساں تو مٹ جاتا ہے رنج
مشکلیں مجھ پر پڑیں اتنی کہ آساں ہو گئیں

*ranj se khugar hua insaan to mit jaata hai ranj
mushkilen mujh par padin itni ki aasan ho gayin*

Literal bridge • When a person becomes accustomed to grief, grief disappears; so many difficulties fell upon me that they became easy.

Poetic turn • Repetition changes the sufferer. The verse does not deny hardship; it observes that endurance alters its felt weight until the impossible becomes familiar.

Grammar clue • se = through/from; par = upon; itni ki = so many that; ho gayin = became, feminine plural.

Words to catch • ranj • se • par • mushkil • aasan • hona

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

05 • MIRZA GHALIB

ریختے کے تمہیں استاد نہیں ہو غالب
کہتے ہیں اگلے زمانے میں کوئی میر بھی تھا

rekhte ke tumhin ustaad nahin ho Ghalib

kehte hain agle zamaane mein koi Mir bhi tha

Literal bridge • Ghalib, you alone are not the master of Rekhta; they say that in an earlier age there was a Mir too.

Poetic turn • A proud poet performs humility with wit. The takhallus turns self-address into literary history, and the praise of Mir enlarges rather than diminishes Ghalib.

Grammar clue • tumhin = you alone; nahin = not; kehte hain = people say; koi...bhi = someone...also.

Words to catch • tum • hi • nahin • kehna • zamaana • mein • koi • bhi

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

06 • MEER TAQI MEER

عشق اک میر بھاری پتھر ہے
کب یہ تجھ ناتواں سے اٹھتا ہے

ishq ik Mir bhaari patthar hai

kab yeh tujh na-tawaan se uthta hai

Literal bridge • Love, Mir, is a heavy stone; when could it be lifted by frail you?

Poetic turn • Love becomes physical weight. By addressing himself as weak, Mir joins confession and warning: the demand of ishq exceeds ordinary human strength.

Grammar clue • kab here is rhetorical—'how could ever?'; se marks the agent/source; yeh points back to ishq.

Words to catch • ishq • kab • yeh • tu • se • hona

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

07 • MEER TAQI MEER

پتّا پتّا بوٹا بوٹا حال ہمارا جانے ہے
جانے نہ جانے گل ہی نہ جانے باغ تو سارا جانے ہے

patta patta boota boota haal hamaara jaane hai
jaane na jaane gul hi na jaane baagh to saara jaane hai

Literal bridge • Every leaf and plant knows our condition; know or not, only the flower does not know—the whole garden knows.

Poetic turn • Nature witnesses what the beloved—the flower—refuses to see. Repetition makes the lover's condition public, while hi isolates the one being who remains unaware.

Grammar clue • hamaara = our; na = not; hi = precisely/alone; saara = whole.

Words to catch • haal • ham • na • hi • sab • khabar

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

08 • MEER TAQI MEER

سرہانے میر کے کوئی نہ بولو
ابھی ٹک روتے روتے سو گیا ہے

sirhaane Mir ke koi na bolo
abhi tuk rote rote so gaya hai

Literal bridge • Speak not beside Mir's pillow; only just now, weeping and weeping, he has fallen asleep.

Poetic turn • The scene is tender and almost domestic. Grief is shown through exhaustion rather than declaration; silence becomes care for a sleep painfully won.

Grammar clue • koi na bolo = let no one speak; rote rote = while repeatedly crying; gaya hai completes the change into sleep.

Words to catch • koi • na • kehna • rona • ab • hona

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

09 • MEER TAQI MEER

ہم ہوئے تم ہوئے کہ میر ہوئے
اس کی زلفوں کے سب اسیر ہوئے

*ham hue tum hue ki Mir hue
us ki zulfon ke sab aseer hue*

Literal bridge • Whether we, you, or Mir—all became captives of that person's tresses.

Poetic turn • The playful list erases hierarchy: speaker, listener and famous poet are equally captured. The beloved's hair becomes the classical snare of beauty.

Grammar clue • hue = became, masculine plural; us ki = that person's; sab = all; ke marks relation.

Words to catch • ham • tum • ki • ke • sab • hona • zulf

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

10 • MEER TAQI MEER

لگانہ دل کو کہیں کیا سنا نہیں تو نے
جو کچھ کہ میر کا اس عاشقی نے حال کیا

*laga na dil ko kahin kya suna nahin tu ne
jo kuchh ki Mir ka is aashiqi ne haal kiya*

Literal bridge • Do not attach the heart anywhere—have you not heard what this loving did to Mir's condition?

Poetic turn • Advice comes from damage already lived. Mir's own name becomes evidence in the warning, while the rhetorical question assumes that his ruin is famous.

Grammar clue • na laga = do not attach; tu ne marks the doer of suna; jo kuchh = whatever/all that.

Words to catch • na • dil • ko • kahin • kya • nahin • tu • ne • haal • karna

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

11 • MEER TAQI MEER

اب تو جاتے ہیں بت کدے سے میر
پھر ملیں گے اگر خدا لایا

*ab to jaate hain but-kade se Mir
phir milenge agar Khuda laaya*

Literal bridge • Now Mir leaves the idol-house; we shall meet again if God brings it about.

Poetic turn • The beloved's place is named an idol-house, preserving the ghazal's tension between worship and romantic devotion. Hope remains, but reunion is surrendered to divine will.

Grammar clue • ab = now; se = from; phir = again; agar = if; laaya = brought.

Words to catch • ab • jaana • se • phir • milna • agar • khuda

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

12 • MOMIN KHAN MOMIN

تم مرے پاس ہوتے ہو گویا
جب کوئی دوسرا نہیں ہوتا

*tum mere paas hote ho goya
jab koi doosra nahin hota*

Literal bridge • You are near me, as if, when no one else is present.

Poetic turn • The grammar leaves a productive uncertainty: is the beloved nearest in solitude, or only imagined then? Goya makes absence feel almost like presence without resolving it.

Grammar clue • mere paas = near/with me; goya = as if; jab = when; koi...nahin = no one.

Words to catch • tum • paas • hona • goya • jab • koi • nahin

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

13 • MOMIN KHAN MOMIN

تم ہمارے کسی طرح نہ ہوئے
ورنہ دنیا میں کیا نہیں ہوتا

*tum hamaare kisi tarah na hue
warna duniya mein kya nahin hota*

Literal bridge • You did not become ours in any way; otherwise, what does not happen in the world?

Poetic turn • The whole world seems capable of miracles except the one desired transformation. Warna turns private failure into a witty claim about possibility itself.

Grammar clue • hamaare = ours; kisi tarah = in any manner; na hue = did not become; warna = otherwise.

Words to catch • tum • ham • koi • na • hona • warna • duniya • mein • kya • nahin

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

14 • MOMIN KHAN MOMIN

وہ جو ہم میں تم میں قرار تھا تمہیں یاد ہو کہ نہ یاد ہو
وہی یعنی وعدہ نباہ کا تمہیں یاد ہو کہ نہ یاد ہو

*woh jo ham mein tum mein qaraar tha tumhen yaad ho ki na yaad ho
wahi yaani waada nibaah ka tumhen yaad ho ki na yaad ho*

Literal bridge • That bond which existed between us—whether you remember or not; namely, the promise of constancy—whether you remember or not.

Poetic turn • The repeated refrain sounds restrained, but it is an accusation. Memory becomes the test of loyalty, and uncertainty about remembrance deepens the hurt.

Grammar clue • woh jo = that which; ham mein tum mein = between us; ho ki na ho = whether it is or is not.

Words to catch • woh • jo • ham • mein • tum • yaad • na • hona • ka

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

15 • BAHADUR SHAH ZAFAR

لگتا نہیں ہے دل مرا اجڑے دیار میں
کس کی بنی ہے عالمِ ناپائیدار میں

*lagta nahin hai dil mera ujde dayaar mein
kis ki bani hai aalam-e-na-paayedaar mein*

Literal bridge • My heart does not settle in this ruined land; whose life has ever held together in an impermanent world?

Poetic turn • A devastated homeland becomes a philosophy of impermanence. The first line is historical and intimate; the second widens exile into the condition of everyone.

Grammar clue • mera = my; mein = in; kis ki = whose; na-paayedaar = not enduring.

Words to catch • nahin • dil • dayaar • mein • ki • hona

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

16 • BAHADUR SHAH ZAFAR

نہ تھی حال کی جب ہمیں اپنے خبر رہے دیکھتے اوروں کے عیب و ہنر
پڑی اپنی برائیوں پر جو نظر تو نگاہ میں کوئی برا نہ رہا

*na thi haal ki jab hamen apne khabar rahe dekhte auron ke aib-o-hunar
padi apni buraiyon par jo nazar to nigaah mein koi bura na raha*

Literal bridge • When we lacked knowledge of our own condition, we watched others' faults and merits; once our gaze fell on our own wrongs, no one remained bad in our sight.

Poetic turn • Self-knowledge changes moral vision. The couplet moves from judging others to examining oneself, and compassion arrives through humility rather than command.

Grammar clue • jab = when; apne = one's own; auron ke = others'; aib-o-hunar uses the Persian and-connector; koi...na = no one.

Words to catch • na • jab • ham • khabar • dekhna • ke • aib • hunar • par • jo • koi • bura

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

17 • BAHADUR SHAH ZAFAR

ظفر آدمی اس کو نہ جانے گا وہ ہو کیسا ہی صاحبِ فہم و ذکا
جسے عیش میں یادِ خدا نہ رہی جسے طیش میں خوفِ خدا نہ رہا

*Zafar aadmi us ko na jaaniyega woh ho kaisa hi saahib-e-fahm-o-zaka
jise aish mein yaad-e-Khuda na rahi jise taish mein khauf-e-Khuda na raha*

Literal bridge • Do not count as fully human one who, however intelligent, forgets God in ease and loses fear of God in rage.

Poetic turn • Intelligence alone is not character. Zafar tests humanity in two opposite conditions: comfort should retain gratitude, and anger should retain restraint.

Grammar clue • us ko = that person; na jaaniyega = do not regard; kaisa hi = however; jise = the one whom/to whom.

Words to catch • woh • ko • na • kaise • hi • mein • yaad • khuda • rehna

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

18 • SHEIKH IBRAHIM ZAUQ

لائی حیات آئے قضا لے چلی چلے
اپنی خوشی نہ آئے نہ اپنی خوشی چلے

*laayi hayaat aaye qaza le chali chale
apni khushi na aaye na apni khushi chale*

Literal bridge • Life brought us, death came and led us away; neither did we come by our own wish nor depart by our own wish.

Poetic turn • Human agency is placed between two uncontrollable events. The balanced verbs—brought, came, took, went—make life resemble a journey whose endpoints are not chosen.

Grammar clue • laayi and le chali are feminine because hayaat/qaza are feminine; na...na = neither...nor.

Words to catch • hayaat • aana • lena • jaana • na • khushi

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

19 • SHEIKH IBRAHIM ZAUQ

نہ ہوا پر نہ ہوا میر کا انداز نصیب
ذوق یاروں نے بہت زور غزل میں مارا

na hua par na hua Mir ka andaaz naseeb

Zauq yaaron ne bahut zor ghazal mein maara

Literal bridge • It was not attained—the style of Mir was not attained—though friends exerted themselves greatly in the ghazal.

Poetic turn • Zauq praises Mir through comic defeat. Labour and technique are not dismissed, but an inimitable andaaz remains beyond effort.

Grammar clue • na hua repeats for emphasis; ka marks possession; yaaron ne marks the doers; mein = in.

Words to catch • na • hona • par • ka • hunar • ne • mein • marna

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

20 • DAGH DEHLVI

خوب پردہ ہے کہ چلمن سے لگے بیٹھے ہیں
صاف چھپتے بھی نہیں سامنے آتے بھی نہیں

khoob parda hai ki chilman se lage baithe hain

saaf chhupte bhi nahin saamne aate bhi nahin

Literal bridge • What a fine veil: they sit close to the screen—neither fully hidden nor coming openly before us.

Poetic turn • Concealment becomes flirtation. The beloved chooses the charged middle position—near enough to be sensed, withheld enough to preserve longing.

Grammar clue • se = against/by; bhi nahin...bhi nahin = neither...nor; saamne = in front; aate = come.

Words to catch • khoob • parda • chilman • se • bhi • nahin • saamne • aana

Text checked against [Rekhta](#)

A Four-Week Practice Rhythm

WEEK 1	WEEK 2	WEEK 3	WEEK 4
Words 1–25 Pronouns, relations, first turns Couplets 1–5	Words 26–50 Questions, time and distance Couplets 6–10	Words 51–75 Core verbs and qualities Couplets 11–15	Words 76–100 Classical pivots and places Couplets 16–20

Daily 20-Minute Session

5 minutes • Review five word cards aloud; recall meaning before looking.

5 minutes • Take one couplet and mark pronouns, glue words and verb.

5 minutes • Listen to a sung or recited ghazal; tally recognised words only.

5 minutes • Speak one compound and one practice phrase from memory.

Self-Test: Can You Decode the Frame?

1. Who is speaking, and who is addressed?
2. Which marker shows possession, location, source or object?
3. What is the verb stem? Is the action present, completed or continuing?
4. Where does the thought turn—question, negation, contrast, emphasis or condition?
5. What image survives after the literal meaning is clear?

Quick Index • All 100 New Words

Cover the meaning column, identify the Roman word and Urdu shape, then use the phrase as your recall check.

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING	TRY IT
1	میں	main	I; the speaker referring to oneself	main tanha hoon
2	ہم	ham	we; sometimes a dignified poetic I	ham beqaraar hain
3	تو	tu	you; intimate, familiar, devotional or disrespectful by context	tu meri dua hai
4	تم	tum	you; familiar and widely used	tum paas ho
5	آپ	aap	you; respectful or formal	aap ka karam
6	وہ	woh	that; he, she or they by context	woh mera khwaab hai
7	یہ	yeh	this; he, she or they nearby by context	yeh dard kya hai
8	کوئی	koi	someone, anyone, some	koi yaad aaya
9	سب	sab	all, everyone, everything	sab jaante hain
10	خود	khud	self; oneself; personally	khud par yaqeen
11	کا	ka	of; belonging to, used with a masculine singular noun	dil ka raaz
12	کی	ki	of; belonging to, used with a feminine noun	raat ki khaamoshi
13	کے	ke	of; belonging to, used with masculine plural or oblique forms	gham ke saaye

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING	TRY IT
14	کو	ko	to; toward; marks a recipient or object	mujh ko yaad hai
15	سے	se	from, with, by, than	dil se kaho
16	میں	mein	in, inside, within	dil mein raaz hai
17	پر	par	on, upon, at; sometimes but	raah par tanha
18	تک	tak	until, up to, as far as	umr bhar tak
19	لیے	liye	for; for the sake of	tere liye dua
20	بغیر	baghair	without	tere baghair tanha
21	جو	jo	who, which, that; the one who	jo dil mein hai
22	جب	jab	when	jab tum aaye
23	اگر	agar	if	agar woh aaye
24	مگر	magar	but, however	chaaha magar paaya nahin
25	لیکن	lekin	but, however	dard hai lekin sukoon bhi
26	ورنہ	warna	otherwise; or else	aa jao warna der hogi
27	پھر	phir	again; then; after that	phir yaad aaya
28	اب	ab	now	ab kya kahen

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING	TRY IT
29	بھی	bhi	also, too, even	dard bhi sukoon bhi
30	ہی	hi	indeed, precisely, only	tum hi mehboob ho
31	کیا	kya	what; also a question marker	yeh kya hai
32	کیوں	kyun	why	dil kyun udaas hai
33	کیسے	kaise	how; in what manner	kaise kahen
34	کون	kaun	who	woh kaun hai
35	کہاں	kahan	where	manzil kahan hai
36	کب	kab	when	visaal kab hoga
37	نہیں	nahin	not; no	main tanha nahin
38	نہ	na	not; do not; or, in repeated alternatives	mujhe bhool na jaana
39	مت	mat	do not; prohibitive marker	door mat jaao
40	گویا	goya	as if, so to speak	goya khwaab ho
41	آج	aaj	today	aaj dil udaas hai
42	کل	kal	yesterday or tomorrow; context decides	kal phir milenge
43	کبھی	kabhi	sometimes, ever, at some time	kabhi yaad karna
44	ہمیشہ	hamesha	always	hamesha tera khayaal

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING	TRY IT
45	یہاں	yahan	here	yahan koi nahin
46	وہاں	wahan	there	woh wahan hai
47	کہیں	kahin	somewhere, anywhere; sometimes perhaps	kahin door
48	پاس	paas	near, beside; in one's possession	mere paas raho
49	دور	door	far, distant	dil se door
50	سامنے	saamne	in front of, before, face-to-face	mere saamne
51	ہونا	hona	to be, happen or become	kya hua
52	کرنا	karna	to do, make or perform	yaad karna
53	آنا	aana	to come	yaad aana
54	جانا	jaana	to go; also a passive/helper verb in compounds	door jaana
55	رہنا	rehna	to stay, remain, live	paas rehna
56	ملنا	milna	to meet, be found, receive or unite	phir milenge
57	دیکھنا	dekhna	to see, look at, witness	tum ko dekhna
58	کہنا	kehna	to say, tell or call	dil ki baat kehna
59	سننا	sunna	to hear, listen	meri faryaad suno

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING	TRY IT
60	دینا	dena	to give, allow or cause	dil dena
61	لینا	lena	to take, receive or bring an action to oneself	dil le liya
62	رکھنا	rakhna	to keep, place or maintain	yaad rakhna
63	کھونا	khona	to lose	sukoon khona
64	پانا	paana	to obtain, attain, find	manzil paana
65	چاہنا	chahna	to want; to love	tum ko chahna
66	مانگنا	maangna	to ask for, request, seek	dua maangna
67	رونا	rona	to cry, weep	gham mein rona
68	ہنسنا	hansna	to laugh, smile	hans kar kehna
69	جینا	jeena	to live	ishq mein jeena
70	مرنا	marna	to die; to be devoted to someone in idiom	gham se marna
71	اچھا	achchha	good, fine, well	haal achchha hai
72	برا	bura	bad, wrong, morally objectionable	koi bura nahin
73	خوب	khoob	very, excellently; beautiful or fine	khoob kaha
74	کم	kam	less, few, insufficient	bahut kam
75	زیادہ	zyada	more, excessive	zyada door

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING	TRY IT
76	آسان	aasan	easy	sab aasan hai
77	مشکل	mushkil	difficult; a difficulty or problem	mushkil safar
78	نادان	naadaan	naive, innocent, unknowing	dil-e-naadaan
79	پریشان	pareshan	troubled, disturbed, scattered	dil pareshan hai
80	اداس	udaas	sad, melancholy, low in spirit	udaas shaam
81	حال	haal	condition, state, present situation	haal-e-dil
82	سبب	sabab	cause, reason	dard ka sabab
83	دوا	dawa	medicine, remedy	gham ki dawa
84	خبر	khavar	news, knowledge, awareness	mujhe khabar hai
85	اثر	asar	effect, influence, impression	dua ka asar
86	کرم	karam	grace, favour, generosity	aap ka karam
87	ستم	sitam	cruelty, oppression, torment	tera sitam
88	گلہ	gila	complaint, grievance	dil ka gila
89	عیب	aib	fault, defect, flaw	apna aib
90	ہنر	hunar	skill, art, talent, virtue	shairi ka hunar

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING	TRY IT
91	پردہ	parda	curtain, veil, concealment	parda-e-raaz
92	چلمن	chilman	screen, lattice curtain or blind	chilman ke paas
93	در	dar	door, threshold	dar-e-mehboob
94	دیوار	deewar	wall	ghar ki deewar
95	راہ	raah	road, way, path	raah-e-ishq
96	منزل	manzil	destination, stage of a journey	manzil-e-ishq
97	گھر	ghar	home, house	dil ka ghar
98	شہر	shehar	city	shehar-e-dil
99	کوچہ	kuucha	lane, street; especially the beloved's lane	kuucha-e-yaar
100	دیار	dayaar	land, region, abode, homeland	dayaar-e-dil

Where to Go Next

لفظ سے خط تک

Volume 3 can now begin the script properly. Because you already know 200 words and the working structure of a line, the Urdu alphabet can be taught through familiar poetry rather than isolated letter drills.

A strong completion test • Choose any five close readings in this volume. If you can identify speaker, addressee, markers, verb and poetic turn before reading the explanation, you are ready for script-based study.

Your Bridge into Volume 3

- 1 • **SEE** • Return to the Quick Index and recognise ten familiar word-shapes without reading the Roman column.
- 2 • **HEAR** • Recite one close reading slowly, pointing to each Urdu line while following its Roman sound.
- 3 • **TRACE** • Notice repeated letter-shapes across words you already know; script study will now attach names to familiar forms.

Reference Note

Texts • The 20 classical couplets were checked against their individual Rekhta pages, linked below each reading. Spellings and transliteration conventions vary; this guide keeps a listener-friendly Roman system consistent with Volume 1.

Further listening • Explore complete ghazals and poet pages in the Rekhta Poetry Archive. [Open Rekhta](#)